

0.0.1 The Noble Lineages

1. There are, O bhikkhus, these four noble lineages that are regarded as primordial, long standing, traditional, ancient, faultless, never before been faulted, not being faulted, will not be faulted, not disdained by wise samanas and brahmanas. Which four?

2. Here, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu is contented with any robe whatsoever, and he speaks in praise of contentment with any robe whatsoever, and he does not undertake inappropriate means for gains with robe as a cause. He is not perturbed if he does not gain a robe, and is not bound to the robes that he gains. He makes use of them uninfatuated, unruffled, as one who sees the danger in them, as one who knows the escape from them. Yet, he neither praises himself nor disparages others because of his contentment with any robe whatsoever. He is indeed skillful therein, energetic, contemplative, mindful. This, O bhikkhus, is called a bhikkhu who stands in an ancient, primordial, noble lineage.

3. Furthermore, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu is contented with any almsfood whatsoever, and he speaks in praise of contentment with any almsfood whatsoever, and he does not undertake inappropriate means for gains with almsfood as a cause. He is not perturbed if he does not gain a almsfood, and is not bound to the almsfood that he gains. He makes use of them uninfatuated, unruffled,

as one who sees the danger in them, as one who knows the escape from them. Yet, he neither praises himself nor disparages others because of his contentment with any almsfood whatsoever. He is indeed skillful therein, energetic, contemplative, mindful. This, O bhikkhus, is called a bhikkhu who stands in an ancient, primordial, noble lineage.

4. Furthermore, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu is contented with any lodging whatsoever, and he speaks in praise of contentment with any lodging whatsoever, and he does not undertake inappropriate means for gains with lodging as a cause. He is not perturbed if he does not gain a lodging, and is not bound to the lodging that he gains. He makes use of them uninfatuated, unruffled, as one who sees the danger in them, as one who knows the escape from them. Yet, he neither praises himself nor disparages others because of his contentment with any lodging whatsoever. He is indeed skillful therein, energetic, contemplative, mindful. This, O bhikkhus, is called a bhikkhu who stands in an ancient, primordial, noble lineage.

5. Furthermore, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu delights in enculturation [of the wholesome], is delighted with enculturation [of the wholesome], delights in abandoning [of the unwholesome], is delighted with abandoning [of the unwholesome]. Yet, he neither praises himself nor disparages others because of his delight in enculturation

[of the wholesome], is delighted with enculturation [of the wholesome], delight in abandoning [of the unwholesome], is delighted with abandoning [of the unwholesome]. He is indeed skillful therein, energetic, contemplative, mindful. This, O bhikkhus, is called a bhikkhu who stands in an ancient, primordial, noble lineage.

6. These, O bhikkhus, are the four noble lineages that are regarded as primordial, long standing, traditional, ancient, faultless, never before been faulted, not being faulted, will not be faulted, not disdained by wise samanas and brahmanas.

7. Moreover, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu endowed with these four noble lineages, even if he dwells in the eastern quarter, he conquers discontent, discontent does not conquer him. even if he dwells in the western quarter, he conquers discontent, discontent does not conquer him. even if he dwells in the northern quarter, he conquers discontent, discontent does not conquer him. even if he dwells in the southern quarter, he conquers discontent, discontent does not conquer him. What is the reason for that? Because, O bhikkhus, the wise one is a conquerer of delight and discontent.

68. No discontent conquers the hero,
the hero is not vanquished by discontent;
rather, the wise one conquers discontent,
for the wise one is indeed a vanquisher of

discontent.

69. What could obstruct the dispeller,
the one divested of all kamma;
just like a big coin of gold from the Jambu
River,
who is fit to blame him;
even the devas praise him,
by Brahma too, he is praised.